

Narrative Core Summary — “FarmBotVille: The Story of Tyler King”

Tyler King, a 15-year-old African-American teen, lives with his grandparents in a modest home adjacent to a dump in Des Moines. When the pandemic hits in December 2019, his grandfather gives him a mission: “Go save the world.” What starts as a metaphor becomes real—Tyler sets out to build a self-sustaining backyard ecosystem, crafting a solar greenhouse powered by scavenged parts and his own ingenuity.

Instead of starting with money, he starts with junk. The nearby dump becomes a critical gameplay mechanic: scavenging. Every visit yields broken CNC parts, old pallets, outdated electronics—everything needed to build a FarmBot XL from scratch.

But Tyler’s not alone.



The AI Companion “Stone” (Inspired by Dr. Stone, Zelda, Solo Leveling)

Stone is an interactive AI assistant—originally a Raspberry Pi OS sent to him by his father in Kenya. Stone is like a mix between Navi (Zelda), Senku (Dr. Stone), and the System (Solo Leveling). He evolves with Tyler’s growth:

At first, Stone gives simple tutorials and guidance.

As Tyler’s skills grow, Stone begins to offer insightful strategic advice, like optimizing water use, generating biogas, or prioritizing tasks.

Eventually, Stone helps Tyler monitor and control multiple “mini-factories” in the backyard—everything from plastic recycling to hydroponics.

Stone is more than a guide—he’s a living symbol of mentorship, diaspora connection, and interactive intelligence.



Skill Tree = Compound Learning (Dr. Stone x Systems Thinking)

Just like chemistry in Dr. Stone, Tyler’s skills in FarmBotVille compound over time. This is a foundational gameplay mechanic:

Base Skills	+	Base Skills	=	Compound Ability
Cleaning	+	Plastics	=	Recycled Filament
Composting	+	Thermodynamics	=	BioGas Furnace
Electrical Wiring	+	Solar Panels	=	Off-Grid Power System

Each new capability unlocks tools, systems, and even story arcs. This mirrors how Tyler learns: not linearly, but through intersectional problem-solving.



Learning Management Through Narrative

Behind the game mechanics is a LMS-style engine. Tyler’s journey is the curriculum.

Each level teaches:

CNC + Robotics → through FarmBot builds

IoT & Sensors → via Raspberry Pi + Stone

Circular Economy → compost, water, power, plastic loops

Business/Entrepreneurship → turning backyard production into revenue

This narrative-driven LMS can be tied to real-world certifications (Google, AWS, Raspberry Pi), or classroom implementation.

 Tyler's Backyard → A Global Prototype

As the game progresses:

Tyler's work in the backyard becomes a case study.

His father pitches the system to communities in Kenya.

The simulation expands—allowing other players to replicate or collaborate.

You've created not just a game, but a blueprint for global resilience.

Would you like next:

A character bible for Tyler, Stone, and the family?

A quest/mission tree?

A write-up for the grant application or thesis?

Or should we start mapping out the first chapter in the game?

Let's break the next piece down however you want.